

tristarlocksmith.com

SEO / GEO / AEO Audit Report

FULL AUDIT

SEO

6

On Track

GEO

7

On Track

AEO

6

On Track

June 27, 2026

Prepared with the SEO / GEO / AEO Audit Skill

Executive Summary

Tristar Locksmith sits on a genuinely strong technical foundation — 162 programmatic service+city pages with unique, non-spun content, comprehensive JSON-LD (Locksmith, WebSite, Service, FAQPage, BreadcrumbList, BlogPosting), an AI-ready llms.txt with full markdown mirrors, clean flat URLs, and analytics fully wired. That foundation is currently being held back by three high-impact, fixable defects. First, every one of the ~200 indexable pages renders a duplicated brand suffix in its title tag — the homepage title is "24/7 Locksmith Knoxville, TN | Tristar Locksmith, Knoxville, TN | Tristar Locksmith, Knoxville, TN" (97 chars) and money pages repeat "Tristar" three times — because the root layout's title template re-wraps a string that buildMetadata has already suffixed. Second, /robots.txt returns HTTP 404 (the [serviceCity] catch-all swallows it), so crawlers get no directives and no sitemap pointer from robots. Third, the 27 city hub pages are thin (~350 words, no FAQ) and — critically — do not link to the very money pages they should feed (e.g. /service-areas/knoxville links to the generic /services/car-lockout, never to /car-lockout-knoxville), leaving 162 pages internally orphaned. Fix these three plus the empty blog and the double-encoded meta descriptions, and this site is positioned to outrank most of the Knoxville locksmith field on white-hat fundamentals alone.

Dimension	Score	Status	Key Takeaway
SEO	6/10	On Track	Excellent architecture undermined by a site-wide title-tag bug, a 404 robots.txt, and orphaned money pages.
GEO	7/10	On Track	llms.txt, .md mirrors and answer capsules are ahead of competitors; E-E-A-T (owner, tenure, license) is thin.
AEO	6/10	On Track	Answer capsules + FAQ schema on money pages are strong; area pages and homepage lack FAQ schema; blog is empty.
Combined	19/30		

Pages Audited

Live crawl (homepage, robots.txt, sitemap.xml/249 URLs, rendered titles across every page type, sample money/area/service pages) plus a full read of the production codebase for exact metadata, schema and content templates.

URL / Pattern	Type	Notes
/	Homepage	buildMetadata; Locksmith + WebSite JSON-LD live. Title suffix duplicated.
/services	Services index	Lists 9 service cards. Title suffix duplicated.
/service-areas	Areas index	Lists 27 area cards. Title suffix duplicated.
/service-areas/{city} ×27	City hub	Thin (~350w), NO FAQ, does NOT link to {service}-{city} money pages.
/services/{slug} ×9	Service detail	~300-400w, 3 unique FAQs each, Service+FAQ schema. Solid.
/service-{city} ×162	Service+City money page	Unique templated content, answer capsule, 3+ FAQs, 3 schemas. Title triple-brands.
/about	About	~350w. No owner, no years, no license #. Weak E-E-A-T.

URL / Pattern	Type	Notes
/contact	Contact	NAP, hours, lead form, area list. Good.
/reviews	Reviews	7 testimonials; '5.0 · 127+'. No on-page Review/AggregateRating schema.
/blog	Blog index	EMPTY — 0 posts published. Nav links to nothing.
/p/{slug} ×3	PPC landing	1,200-1,500w, noindex (correct). car-key-replacement, house-lockout, car-lockout.
/llms.txt, /llms-full.txt	AI mirror	Present. Strong GEO signal.
AI markdown	index.md, services.md, about.md, etc. Strong GEO signal.	
/robots.txt	Robots	RETURNS HTTP 404 — caught by [serviceCity] catch-all. Critical.
/sitemap.xml	Sitemap	200 OK. 249 URLs. Healthy.

SEO Analysis — 6/10

Technical On-Page

Signal	Finding	Status
Title tags	Site-wide DUPLICATED suffix. Homepage: "... Tristar Locksmith, Knoxville, TN Tristar Locksmith, Knoxville, TN". Money pages triple "Tristar". Root layout title.template re-wraps buildMetadata's already-suffixed string.	Missing
Meta descriptions	Mostly good & unique, but double-encoded ampersands render as "Licensed &insured" on area + combo pages (literal "&" in source escaped again).	Needs Attention
robots.txt	HTTP 404 in production. robots.ts lives in (site)/ where the [serviceCity] catch-all intercepts it. No crawl rules or sitemap pointer served.	Missing
Canonical tags	Self-referencing canonical on every page via buildMetadata alternates.canonical. Correct.	Good
Sitemap	/sitemap.xml returns 200 with 249 URLs incl. all combos, areas, services, .md mirrors. Excellent.	Good
Robots meta	index,follow on public pages; noindex,nofollow on /lp PPC pages. Correct.	Good
Viewport / mobile	width=device-width present site-wide. Mobile-first layout + sticky call button.	Good
URL structure	Clean flat keyword URLs (/car-lockout-knoxville). Model implementation.	Good
Open Graph / Twitter	OG title/desc/url/image (1200×630) + Twitter summary_large_image via buildMetadata. og:image asset should be verified to exist.	Good
Heading hierarchy	Single H1 per page; logical H2/H3. Area pages put 'Services/Quick Links' as H3 (footer-ish) — minor.	Good
Image alt text	RecentProjects alt is descriptive; hero alt="" (decorative, acceptable); logo alt='Tristar Locksmith' (could add 'Knoxville TN').	Needs Attention
Internal linking	Money pages cross-link siblings/nearby, BUT city hubs do NOT link to their money pages → 162 orphaned from their hub.	Needs Attention

Content Quality

Signal	Finding	Status
Money pages (162)	Genuinely unique per combo: whatWeDo (~150w), scenario (~80w), 5 H2 sections, answer capsule, 3+ FAQs with landmarks/neighborhoods/ZIPs. NOT thin doorway pages.	Good
Service pages (9)	~300-400w, 5-6 features, 3 unique FAQs each. Solid depth.	Good
City hub pages (27)	~350w, unique intro paragraph, but no FAQ, no service-specific detail, no links to money pages.	Needs Attention
About page	No owner/founder name, no years-in-business, no license number, no team. Competitors cite 'since 1981', '21 years'.	Needs Attention
Blog	0 posts. Whole informational keyword universe uncovered.	Missing
Keyword coverage gaps	No combo pages for ignition-repair, emergency-locksmith, key-fob-programming; matrix only covers 6 of 9 services.	Needs Attention

Structured Data

Signal	Finding	Status
Locksmith (LocalBusiness)	Site-wide via (site) layout. Name, phone, geo, hours, 27 areaServed cities, aggregateRating 5.0/127, priceRange. Renders live.	Good
WebSite + SearchAction	Site-wide. Correct.	Good
Service / LocksmithService	On /services/{slug} and every money page. Correct serviceType + areaServed City.	Good
FAQPage	On money pages, service pages, landing pages. NOT on city hubs or homepage.	Needs Attention
BreadcrumbList	On money pages. Not on service/area/standalone pages.	Needs Attention
AggregateRating / Review	AggregateRating only inside global Locksmith schema. No per-Review schema on /reviews. 5.0/127 is unverifiable — confirm before relying on it.	Needs Attention
BlogPosting	Builder exists, but blog is empty so unused.	Needs Attention

GEO / AI Search Analysis — 7/10

GEO optimizes for AI answer engines that synthesize and cite sources. Tristar is unusually well-prepared for a local business.

E-E-A-T Assessment

Signal	Finding	Status
Entity clarity	Brand named consistently 'Tristar Locksmith'; clear what/where via llms.txt, .md mirrors, About, schema. Strong for AI extraction.	Good
About / who-we-are	Origin of name + mission present, but no named owner, no tenure, no credentials. AI engines have little authoritative bio to cite.	Needs Attention

Signal	Finding	Status
Contact / NAP	Phone, hours, city, service area clear. Footer address has spacing typo: '5825 Pine Needle Ln, Knoxville TN,37921'.	Needs Attention
Trust signals	5.0/127 rating, licensed/insured claims, testimonials. Review count unverifiable — confirm.	Needs Attention
Organization schema / sameAs	Locksmith schema present but NO sameAs links (no GBP, Facebook, Yelp, BBB). Weakens entity graph for AI.	Needs Attention
Licenses / certifications	Claims 'Licensed & Insured' but no TN license number or proof. Add if real; AI & users reward verifiable facts.	Needs Attention

Content for AI Synthesis

Signal	Finding	Status
Factual density	Money pages cite ZIPs, neighborhoods, landmarks, hours, phone — citable facts. Good.	Good
Answer capsule	40-60 word direct-answer block at top of every money page. Excellent for AI Overviews/Perplexity.	Good
llms.txt / llms-full.txt	Both present + per-page .md mirrors. Ahead of all Knoxville competitors checked.	Good
HTTPS / crawlability	HTTPS, static-generated (not JS-only). AI crawlers can read it. robots.txt 404 is the one gap.	Needs Attention
Original perspective	Content is solid but generic locksmith prose. No proprietary data, pricing ranges, or local guides AI would prefer to cite.	Needs Attention

AEO / Featured Snippet Analysis — 6/10

Signal	Finding	Status
Direct-answer paragraphs	Answer capsules on money pages are ideal featured-snippet bait. Service pages lack a capsule.	Good
Question-phrased headings	FAQ questions are natural-language. Body H2s are statements, not questions — add a few question H2s.	Needs Attention
FAQ schema	Present on money + service + landing pages. Missing on 27 city hubs and homepage.	Needs Attention
Lists / tables	Some bulleted lists. No comparison tables (e.g. rekey vs replace, key types & price) which win table snippets.	Needs Attention
HowTo / Speakable	None. 'What to do if locked out of your car' HowTo + Speakable on capsules would extend voice/snippet reach.	Needs Attention
Voice / local long-tail	NAP + conversational FAQs support voice. Add 'How much.../How fast.../Can a locksmith...' coverage on every service.	Needs Attention

Priority Recommendations Matrix

Priority	Issue & Fix	Dim.	Effort	Impact
Critical	Duplicated title suffix on all ~200 pages (brand repeated 2-3×, titles 90-130 chars). Fix buildMetadata to use title.absolute and drop the redundant ', Knoxville, TN' template suffix.	SEO	Low (1 file)	Very High
Critical	/robots.txt returns 404. Move robots.ts to src/app/ root (out of the (site) group) or add public/robots.txt with sitemap pointer.	SEO/GEO	Low	High
Critical	Money-page metaTitle templates already end in ' Tristar' then get suffixed again. Shorten templates to ≤60 chars, brand once.	SEO	Low (1 JSON)	Very High
High	City hub pages don't link to their 6 money pages. Add a 'Locksmith services in {city}' link grid → /{service}-{city}. De-orphans 162 pages.	SEO	Medium	Very High
High	Double-encoded '&' in area + combo meta descriptions. Replace literal '&' with '&'.	SEO	Low	Medium
High	Blog empty. Publish a cluster of local informational posts feeding money pages (see Blog Strategy).	SEO/AEO	High	High
High	About page lacks E-E-A-T. Add owner/team, years in business, TN license #, real credentials (only if true).	GEO	Medium	High
High	Add FAQ section + FAQPage schema to the 27 city hub pages (unique Q&A per city).	AEO	Medium	High
Medium	No sameAs links in schema. Add GBP, Facebook, Yelp, BBB URLs to Locksmith schema.	GEO	Low	Medium
Medium	Verify 5.0/127 review count is real & matches Google Business Profile; add per-Review schema on /reviews.	GEO	Low	Medium
Medium	No combo pages for ignition-repair, emergency-locksmith, key-fob-programming. Extend matrix to these high-intent services.	SEO	High	High
Medium	Add a comparison table (rekey vs replace; key types & price ranges) for table snippets.	AEO	Medium	Medium
Quick Win	Fix footer NAP typo '...Knoxville TN,37921' → '...Knoxville, TN 37921'. Keep NAP identical everywhere.	Local	Trivial	Low
Quick Win	Logo alt 'Tristar Locksmith' → 'Tristar Locksmith — Knoxville, TN locksmith'.	SEO	Trivial	Low
Quick Win	Add 2-3 question-phrased H2s per service page + an answer capsule for snippet eligibility.	AEO	Low	Medium

What's Working Well

Strength	Evidence
162 unique money pages	6 services × 27 cities, each with unique whatWeDo, scenario, landmarks, ZIPs, answer capsule and FAQs — white-hat, not doorway pages.
Comprehensive schema	Locksmith, WebSite, Service/LocksmithService, FAQPage, BreadcrumbList, BlogPosting, ItemList — verified rendering live.
AI-ready (GEO)	llms.txt + llms-full.txt + per-page .md mirrors. Few local competitors have this; strong for ChatGPT/Perplexity/Gemini.
Answer capsules (AEO)	40-60 word direct answers atop money pages — exactly what AI Overviews and featured snippets extract.
Clean flat URLs	/car-lockout-knoxville style — keyword-rich, readable, ideal.

Strength	Evidence
Correct PPC hygiene	/lp pages are noindex,nofollow so paid pages don't cannibalize organic.
Conversion focus	Sticky mobile call button, upfront-pricing messaging, lead form on every money page, prominent phone CTA.
Full analytics	GA4, Microsoft Clarity, Vercel Analytics + Speed Insights, Google Ads tag — measurement is in place.

Title Tag Rewrite Table

Root cause: the root layout's `title` template re-wraps a string that `buildMetadata` already suffixed, so the brand appears 2-3×. Fix `buildMetadata` to use `title:{absolute:'... | Tristar Locksmith'}` and shorten money-page `metaTitle` templates. Targets ≤60 chars.

URL	Current (rendered live)	Recommended	Chars
/	24/7 Locksmith Knoxville, TN Tristar Locksmith, Knoxville, TN Tristar Locksmith, Knoxville, TN	24/7 Locksmith in Knoxville, TN Tristar Locksmith	51
/services	Locksmith Services Tristar Locksmith, Knoxville, TN Tristar Locksmith, Knoxville, TN	Locksmith Services in Knoxville, TN Tristar Locksmith	54
/service-areas	Service Areas Tristar Locksmith, Knoxville, TN Tristar Locksmith, Knoxville, TN	Locksmith Service Areas Near Knoxville, TN Tristar	52
/service-areas/knoxville	Locksmith Knoxville, TN Tristar Locksmith, Knoxville, TN Tristar Locksmith, Knoxville, TN	Locksmith in Knoxville, TN Tristar Locksmith	46
/service-areas/farragut	Locksmith Farragut, TN ...(doubled suffix)	Locksmith in Farragut, TN Tristar Locksmith	45
/services/car-lockout	Car Lockout Service Tristar Locksmith, Knoxville, TN Tristar Locksmith, Knoxville, TN	Car Lockout Service in Knoxville, TN Tristar	46
/services/car-key-replacement	Car Key Replacement ...(doubled suffix)	Car Key Replacement Knoxville, TN Tristar	43
/about	About Tristar Locksmith Tristar Locksmith, Knoxville, TN Tristar Locksmith, Knoxville, TN	About Tristar Locksmith Knoxville, TN	39
/contact	Contact Tristar Locksmith ...(doubled suffix)	Contact Tristar Locksmith Knoxville, TN	41
/reviews	Customer Reviews ...(doubled suffix)	Tristar Locksmith Reviews Knoxville, TN	41
/blog	Locksmith Blog ...(doubled suffix)	Locksmith Tips & Guides Tristar Locksmith Blog	48
/car-lockout-knoxville	Car Lockout Knoxville TN Non-Destructive Entry Tristar Tristar Locksmith, Knoxville, TN Tristar Locksmith, Knoxville, TN	Car Lockout Knoxville, TN Tristar Locksmith	45
/car-key-replacement-farragut	Car Key Replacement Farragut TN All Makes Tristar Locksmith ... ×2	Car Key Replacement Farragut, TN Tristar	42
/commercial-locksmith-oak-ridge	Commercial Locksmith Oak Ridge TN Business Locks Tristar ... ×2	Commercial Locksmith Oak Ridge, TN Tristar	44

Meta Description Rewrite Table

URL / Pattern	Current issue	Recommended
/	Good length; fine.	Keep. Optionally add a speed/coverage hook: '...Fast mobile service to Knoxville & 27 nearby cities. Upfront pricing. Call (865) 381-3931.'
/service-areas/{city}	'...rekey, and more. Licensed && insured. Call...' (double-encoded ampersand renders as &)	Replace literal '&' with '&' in the source string so it renders 'Licensed & insured.'
/car-lockout-knoxville	'...on all vehicle makes. Licensed && insured. Call (865) 381-3931.'	Fix to 'Licensed & insured.' (single '&'). Otherwise strong.
/about	Good.	Add a credibility fact once owner/tenure confirmed: '...Locally owned, licensed & insured, serving East TN since {year}.'
/blog	Generic.	'Expert locksmith tips for Knoxville drivers & homeowners — car keys, lockouts, rekeys, security. From Tristar Locksmith.'

H1 / H2 Rewrite Table

URL / Pattern	Current	Recommended
/	H1 "Knoxville's Trusted 24/7 Locksmith" (good)	Keep H1. Add a question H2 'How fast can a locksmith reach me in Knoxville?' with a 40-60w answer capsule above the FAQ.
/service-areas/{city}	H1 "Locksmith in {city}, TN" (good). H2 "Locksmith Services in {city}".	Add H2 'Frequently Asked Questions — {city} Locksmith' + 3 unique FAQs, and an H2 grid 'Popular {city} locksmith services' linking the 6 money pages.
/services/{slug}	H1 = service title only, e.g. "Car Lockout Service".	Localize H1: 'Car Lockout Service in Knoxville, TN'. Add question H2s ('How much does a car lockout cost?').
/service-{city}	H2s are statements ('How Tristar Handles...', 'Transparent Pricing...').	Convert 1-2 to questions ('How much does {service} cost in {city}?') to capture PAA/snippets.
/about	H1 "About Tristar Locksmith"; H2 "Our Story", "Why Choose Tristar?"	Add H2 'Meet the Owner / Our Team', H2 'Licensed & Insured in Tennessee', H2 'Our Service Promise'.

FAQ Recommendations by Page

Homepage

- How much does a locksmith cost in Knoxville?
- How fast can you get to me?
- Are you licensed and insured in Tennessee?
- Do you serve my area / which cities?

Action: Add FAQPage schema (homepage currently has none).

City hub /service-areas/{city}

- What locksmith services do you offer in {city}?
- How fast can a locksmith reach {city}?
- How much does a locksmith cost in {city}?
- What {city} neighborhoods do you cover?

Action: Add FAQPage schema — biggest current gap (27 pages, 0 FAQ).

Car key replacement

- Can a locksmith make a car key with no original?
- Can you program a key fob / push-to-start key?
- How much is a replacement car key in Knoxville?
- Is it cheaper than the dealership?

Action: Already has FAQ on /lp; mirror to /services/car-key-replacement + combos.

Ignition repair (new)

- Can a locksmith fix or replace a car ignition?
- Signs your ignition is failing?
- How much does ignition repair cost?

Action: Create page + FAQPage schema.

Commercial

- Can a locksmith rekey a business?
- Do you install master key systems / access control?
- Can you handle an after-hours business lockout?

Action: Add to /services/commercial-locksmith + combos.

Emergency/general

- Do locksmiths work after hours?
- What should I do if I'm locked out of my car?
- What info should I have ready before calling?
- Can a locksmith unlock my house without damage?

Action: Use on /services/emergency-locksmith + homepage.

Schema Recommendations by Page

Page	Recommended schema additions
Homepage	Add FAQPage (homepage FAQs) + ensure Locksmith schema gains sameAs[] (GBP, FB, Yelp, BBB).
/service-areas/{city}	Add FAQPage + BreadcrumbList; consider Service list (areaServed City).
/services/{slug}	Add BreadcrumbList; keep Service + FAQPage.

Page	Recommended schema additions
/reviews	Add Review[] items + page-level AggregateRating (only with verified, real reviews).
/about	Add Organization/LocalBusiness with founder, foundingDate, sameAs (once confirmed).
Blog posts	BlogPosting (exists) + FAQPage per post + author/Person once a real author is named.
Site-wide	Add sameAs[] to the Locksmith node; verify og-image.jpg exists and is 1200×630.

Recommended Homepage JSON-LD

Enhanced Locksmith block built only from facts on the site. Items marked **NEEDS OWNER CONFIRMATION** must be verified before publishing.

```
{
  "@context": "https://schema.org",
  "@type": "Locksmith",
  "@id": "https://tristarlocksmith.com/#business",
  "name": "Tristar Locksmith",
  "url": "https://tristarlocksmith.com",
  "image": "https://tristarlocksmith.com/og-image.jpg",
  "logo": "https://tristarlocksmith.com/images/noo-backgorund.png",
  "telephone": "+1-865-381-3931",
  "priceRange": "$$",
  "address": {
    "@type": "PostalAddress",
    "streetAddress": "5825 Pine Needle Ln",
    "addressLocality": "Knoxville",
    "addressRegion": "TN",
    "postalCode": "37921",
    "addressCountry": "US"
  },
  "geo": { "@type": "GeoCoordinates", "latitude": 35.9606, "longitude": -83.9207 },
  "openingHoursSpecification": {
    "@type": "OpeningHoursSpecification",
    "dayOfWeek": ["Monday", "Tuesday", "Wednesday", "Thursday", "Friday", "Saturday", "Sunday"],
    "opens": "07:00", "closes": "23:30"
  },
  "areaServed": [ { "@type": "City", "name": "Knoxville" }, "...27 cities..." ],
  "makesOffer": [
    { "@type": "Offer", "itemOffered": { "@type": "Service", "name": "Car Lockout" } },
    { "@type": "Offer", "itemOffered": { "@type": "Service", "name": "House Lockout" } },
    { "@type": "Offer", "itemOffered": { "@type": "Service", "name": "Car Key Replacement" } },
    { "@type": "Offer", "itemOffered": { "@type": "Service", "name": "Rekey / Lock Change" } },
    { "@type": "Offer", "itemOffered": { "@type": "Service", "name": "Commercial Locksmith" } },
    { "@type": "Offer", "itemOffered": { "@type": "Service", "name": "Safe Lockout" } }
  ],
  "sameAs": [
    "NEEDS OWNER CONFIRMATION - Google Business Profile URL",
    "NEEDS OWNER CONFIRMATION - Facebook URL",
    "NEEDS OWNER CONFIRMATION - Yelp URL"
  ],
  "aggregateRating": {
    "@type": "AggregateRating",
    "ratingValue": "5.0",
    "reviewCount": "127",
    "bestRating": "5", "worstRating": "1"
  }
}

/* NOTE: streetAddress, foundingDate, license number, ratingValue and
reviewCount must be VERIFIED by the owner. aggregateRating should only
```

be published if it reflects real, verifiable reviews (ideally matching the Google Business Profile count) to avoid a structured-data penalty. */

Keyword Gap Analysis

Target keyword	Current state	Recommended action	Priority
ignition repair Knoxville TN	No dedicated page (only mentioned in nav/footer service list)	Create /services/ignition-repair detail + ignition-repair-{city} combos	High
ignition replacement Knoxville TN	Not targeted	Cover on ignition-repair page (H2 + FAQ)	High
key fob programming Knoxville TN	Not a standalone page; folded into car-key-replacement	Create /services/key-fob-programming + combos; strong commercial intent	High
emergency locksmith Knoxville TN	Service page exists, but NO city combos	Add emergency-locksmith-{city} combos	High
lock repair Knoxville TN	Folded into lock-change	Add explicit H2 + FAQ targeting 'lock repair'	Medium
lock installation Knoxville TN	Covered under lock-change	Add 'lock installation' wording + FAQ	Medium
business lockout Knoxville TN	Implicit under commercial	Add explicit section/FAQ	Medium
locksmith near me	Implicit	Add 'near me' phrasing in city hub intros + GBP optimization (off-site)	Medium
lost car key replacement Knoxville TN	Partial (car-key-replacement)	Add explicit 'lost car key' H2 + FAQ	Medium

Keyword Cannibalization Map

Overlap	Verdict & fix
car-key-replacement: /services/car-key-replacement vs /car-key-replacement-knoxville vs /lp/car-key-replacement	Low risk — /lp is noindex; service page = informational hub, combo = local intent. Keep distinct; ensure service page targets non-geo head term and links down to combos.
'Locksmith {city}' hub vs '{service}-{city}' money pages	Hub should target 'locksmith {city}' (broad) and link to the 6 narrower money pages. Currently hub doesn't link down — fix to clarify hierarchy and avoid flat competition.
Homepage vs /service-areas/knoxville both target 'locksmith Knoxville'	Mild overlap. Differentiate: homepage = brand/'locksmith Knoxville TN'; Knoxville hub = 'locksmith in Knoxville' + neighborhood depth. Internally link homepage→hub with descriptive anchor.
/services index vs individual /services/{slug}	Healthy hub-and-spoke. No action.

Service Page Strategy

Action	Target	Priority	Detail
Create /services/ignition-repair (detail)	ignition repair Knoxville TN	High	Title: 'Ignition Repair & Replacement Knoxville, TN Tristar'. H2s: How we fix ignitions / Signs of a failing ignition / Cost / FAQ. Service+FAQ+Breadcrumb schema.
Create /services/key-fob-programming	key fob programming Knoxville TN	High	Split from car-key-replacement. Target fob/push-to-start intent. FAQ: 'Can you program a key fob?' etc.
Localize 9 service H1s	{service} Knoxville TN	Quick	Append 'in Knoxville, TN' to each service H1; add answer capsule + 2 question H2s.
Add combos for ignition/emergency/fob	{service}-{city}	High	Extend service-city matrix from 6→9 services (×27 cities) once detail pages exist.

Service-Area Page Strategy

- Keep all 27 city hubs — they are unique, not doorway pages. Do NOT add fake addresses/offices.
- Add to EACH hub: (1) a 'Popular locksmith services in {city}' grid linking the 6 /{service}-{city} money pages; (2) 3 unique FAQs + FAQPage schema; (3) BreadcrumbList; (4) one extra paragraph of genuinely local context (neighborhoods/landmarks already in data).
- Cross-link hubs to nearby hubs (already done) AND down to money pages (missing). This single change de-orphans 162 pages and clarifies the topical hierarchy.
- Where a city has thin local data, keep it honest — no invented neighborhoods or landmarks.

Blog Strategy

Topic cluster: pillar = /services/{slug}; supporting posts link up to pillar and across to money pages. 5 posts in 60 days, 5 more by day 90.

Slug	Target keyword	Intent	Internal links to	Schema
car-key-replacement-cost-knoxville	how much does a car key replacement cost knoxville	Informational→commercial	/services/car-key-replacement, /car-key-replacement-knoxville	BlogPosting+FAQPage
locked-out-of-car-what-to-do	what to do when locked out of your car	Informational (HowTo)	/services/car-lockout, /car-lockout-knoxville	BlogPosting+HowTo+FAQPage
rekey-vs-replace-locks	is it cheaper to rekey or replace locks	Commercial investigation	/services/rekey, /services/lock-change	BlogPosting+FAQPage (comparison table)
key-fob-not-working-fixes	car key fob not working	Informational	/services/car-key-replacement (fob)	BlogPosting+FAQPage
signs-ignition-failing	signs your car ignition is going bad	Informational	/services/ignition-repair	BlogPosting+FAQPage
new-home-rekey-checklist-knoxville	should i rekey locks when moving into a new house	Informational→local	/services/rekey, /service-areas/knoxville	BlogPosting+FAQPage

Slug	Target keyword	Intent	Internal links to	Schema
business-lock-security-guide	commercial lock options for small business	Commercial	/services/commercial-locksmith	BlogPosting+FAQPage
how-fast-locksmith-knoxville	how long does a locksmith take to arrive	Local/near-me	homepage, city hubs	BlogPosting+FAQPage
push-to-start-key-replacement	can a locksmith make a push to start key	Commercial	/services/car-key-replacement	BlogPosting+FAQPage
choosing-a-locksmith-knoxville-avoid-scams	how to avoid locksmith scams	Trust/E-E-A-T	/about, homepage	BlogPosting+FAQPage

Internal Linking Plan

- Pillar: /services/{slug} (head term) → links down to all 27 /{service}-{city} money pages for that service.
- Hub: /service-areas/{city} → links to the 6 /{service}-{city} pages for that city (NEW).
- Money pages: already link to sibling services + nearby cities; also link UP to their /services/{slug} pillar and /service-areas/{city} hub.
- Blog → money pages: each post links to 1-2 relevant money/service pages with descriptive anchor (e.g. 'car key replacement in Knoxville').
- Homepage → top hubs (Knoxville, Farragut, Maryville, Oak Ridge) + top services with keyword anchors.

30-Day Implementation Plan — Technical Fixes

- Fix buildMetadata title (use title.absolute, single brand, drop redundant ', Knoxville, TN'). Verify all page types ≤60 chars. [Critical]
- Shorten 6 service metaTitle templates in service-city.json so they don't end in '| Tristar'. [Critical]
- Fix /robots.txt 404: move robots.ts to src/app/ root (or add public/robots.txt) with Sitemap line. Re-test with curl. [Critical]
- Replace '&' → '&' in area + combo meta description strings. [High]
- Fix footer NAP typo; standardize NAP string everywhere. [Quick Win]
- Add 'sameAs' (GBP, Facebook, Yelp, BBB) to Locksmith schema; verify og-image.jpg. [Medium]
- Confirm 5.0/127 review count matches Google Business Profile (owner). [Medium]

60-Day Growth Plan — Content & Linking

- Add 'Popular services in {city}' money-page link grid to all 27 city hubs (de-orphan 162 pages). [High]
- Add 3 unique FAQs + FAQPage schema to all 27 city hubs. [High]
- Add FAQPage schema to homepage; add question H2 + answer capsule. [High]

- Rebuild About page with owner/team, tenure, TN license #, service promise (only true facts) + Organization schema. [High]
- Localize 9 service-page H1s and add answer capsules + question H2s. [Medium]
- Publish first 5 blog posts from the Blog Strategy, each linking to money pages. [High]

90-Day Authority Plan — Expansion & Off-Site

- Create /services/ignition-repair and /services/key-fob-programming detail pages. [High]
- Extend service-city matrix 6→9 services (add ignition-repair, emergency-locksmith, key-fob-programming combos). [High]
- Publish remaining 5 blog posts; build internal links blog→money. [Medium]
- Add comparison tables (rekey vs replace; key types & price ranges) for table snippets. [Medium]
- Add per-Review schema on /reviews (verified reviews only); pursue real GBP reviews. [Medium]
- Off-site: optimize Google Business Profile, build local citations (NAP), earn links from East-TN sites. [High]
- Measure: track rankings for the 19 target keywords + city terms; iterate on pages stuck on page 2.

Competitor Snapshot — Knoxville, TN

Top competitors observed: **deltalocksmith.com** (target — 21+ years, two physical offices), **Mobile Key Shop** (auto specialist since 1981, 159+ Google reviews, 4.8★), **Knox Car Keys** (since 1994), **Pop-A-Lock of Knoxville**, **Volunteer Lock & Key**, **Larry's Lock & Key**. Pattern: competitors lead with verifiable tenure, real review counts and physical addresses, but most LACK Tristar's programmatic city coverage, llms.txt/AI mirrors and answer-capsule AEO. Tristar can win on (1) breadth of unique local pages, (2) AI/answer-engine readiness and (3) schema depth — provided it also closes the trust gap (named owner, tenure, license, real Google reviews) the competitors already have.

Glossary

Term	Definition
SEO (Search Engine Optimization)	Optimizing pages so traditional search engines (Google, Bing) rank them for relevant queries — titles, headings, content, links, schema, technical health.
GEO (Generative Engine Optimization)	Optimizing so AI answer engines (ChatGPT Search, Perplexity, Gemini, Google AI Overviews) understand, trust and CITE your business — entity clarity, E-E-A-T, factual density, llms.txt.
AEO (Answer Engine Optimization)	Optimizing to win featured snippets, People-Also-Ask, and voice answers — concise 40-60 word answers under question headings, FAQ/HowTo schema, lists and tables.
E-E-A-T	Experience, Expertise, Authoritativeness, Trustworthiness — Google's quality signals. For a locksmith: named owner, tenure, license, real reviews, NAP.
Answer capsule	A 40-60 word direct answer placed high on the page so search/AI engines can lift it as the answer.
Money page	A page built to capture commercial-intent searches and convert (here: /{service}-{city}).
Orphan page	An indexable page that few or no internal links point to — harder for crawlers and users to find and weaker in ranking.
NAP	Name, Address, Phone — must be identical everywhere (site, schema, Google Business Profile) for local trust.

Term	Definition
Schema / JSON-LD	Structured data that labels page facts for machines (business, service, FAQ, breadcrumb, review).
Cannibalization	Two+ of your own pages competing for the same query, splitting signals; fixed with clear hierarchy and internal links.